NEOLABS

SECURITY LABS · SOC LEVEL 1

SOC Investigation Templates

Evidence register, query journal and incident-report forms

Version: week1-prod-237

Publication date: 2026-10-31

Classification: Student Training Material

Authorised synthetic training use only.

Contents

1. NeoLabs SOC Evidence Log Template

2. NeoLabs SOC Query Journal Template

3. NeoLabs SOC Incident Report Template

Source: templates/evidence-log-template.md

NeoLabs SOC Evidence Log Template

> Record evidence used in an authorised investigation. This template is for training and case discipline; it does not replace organisational forensic procedures or legal chain-of-custody requirements.

Case information

Field	Entry
Case / assignment ID	
Analyst	
Assigned pod	
Investigation start	YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC
Report path / link	

Evidence register

Evidence ID	Date/ time collected (UTC)	Event time range	Source system	Evidence type	Collection method / query	Original location	File or record hash, when applicable	Handling / redaction note	Releva
EV-001				Alert / raw event / export / screenshot / config / owner confirmation					

Evidence-quality checks

For each important item, consider:

- Was the source operating during the event period?
- Is the timestamp event time, ingest time or alert time?

- Is the time zone known?
- Could the record be duplicated, delayed or truncated?
- Did a decoder or parser alter the displayed fields?
- Is the value source-generated, user-controlled or enrichment data?
- Is the evidence complete enough for the conclusion?
- Was sensitive data redacted without removing necessary meaning?

Evidence statements

Use one statement per important claim.

EV-___

Observed fact:

Source and time:

What this evidence supports:

What this evidence does not prove:

Quality or visibility limitation:

Related evidence:

Transfer or review record

Date/time UTC	Evidence ID(s)	From	To / reviewer	Purpose	Method	Confirmation

Final checks

- [ ] Every report fact points to an evidence ID or clearly identified source.
- [ ] No credential, private key or enrolment token is included.
- [ ] Personal or cross-pod information is removed or escalated rather than published.
- [ ] Screenshots show the required context and do not replace available raw records.
- [ ] UTC conversions are documented.
- [ ] Negative findings include the source, query and time range.

Source: templates/query-journal-template.md

NeoLabs SOC Query Journal Template

> Record searches as they are performed so another analyst can reproduce the investigation. Replace secrets and private endpoints with approved references; never paste enrolment tokens or private keys.

Case information

Field	Entry
Case / assignment ID	
Analyst	
Assigned pod	
Investigation date	
Primary alert	

Query register

Query ID	Time run (UTC)	Platform / source	Exact query or filter	Event-time range	Result count	Important result or negative finding	Evidence IDs	Next pivot
Q-001		Wazuh / OpenSearch / local tool						

Detailed query record

Q-___

Question being tested:

Data source and index/view:

Exact query/filter/command:

Time field used: Event time / ingest time / other
Time range:
Fields displayed or exported:
Result summary:
Relevant evidence IDs:
Limitations:
Decision / next query:

Query-quality checks

- [ ] The query uses the intended field rather than only free-text search.
- [ ] Exact and analysed fields are distinguished where applicable.
- [ ] The event-time field and time zone are recorded.
- [ ] A zero-result search was checked against source health and retention.
- [ ] Filters inherited from a dashboard or saved view are recorded.
- [ ] Wildcards and broad searches are narrowed before drawing conclusions.
- [ ] Commands were run only against synthetic data or explicitly authorised systems.
- [ ] Output containing sensitive values was redacted before submission.

Investigation summary

Most useful query:

Most important negative finding:

Visibility gap discovered:

Queries recommended for higher-tier review:

Source: templates/incident-report-template.md

NeoLabs SOC Incident Report Template

> Use for authorised VCC exercises and approved synthetic investigations. Replace instructional text before submission. Do not include credentials, private keys, enrolment tokens or unredacted personal information.

1. Report control

Field	Entry
Report title	
Case / assignment ID	
Analyst name	
Track and cohort	SOC Level 1 /
Assigned pod	
Report version	1.0
Prepared at	YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC
Reviewer	
Classification	Training use / confidential programme material as directed

2. Executive summary

Write 3–6 sentences for a reader who may not know Wazuh or the scenario. State:

- what triggered the investigation;
- the affected account, service or asset;
- the most important confirmed facts;
- the current classification and confidence;
- the recommended next action.

Do not include unsupported claims or long raw-log extracts.

3. Alert and detection information

Field	Entry
Alert name	
Alert / rule ID	
Detection source	
Alert creation time	
Earliest confirmed event time	
Tool-assigned severity	
Analyst-assigned priority	
Relevant ATT&CK behaviour	Optional; explain mapping

4. Scope

Affected identities

Identity	Type	Role / context	Confirmed or suspected impact

Affected assets and services

Asset / service	Identifier	Criticality / role	Evidence of impact

Network, file and cloud indicators

Indicator	Type	Source	Relevance and limitation

5. Observed facts

List facts directly supported by evidence. Number each fact so it can be referenced later.

1.
2.
3.

6. Timeline

Use UTC unless the assignment specifies otherwise. Separate event time from ingest or alert time when relevant.

UTC time	Source	Entity	Observed activity	Evidence reference	Confidence

7. Evidence reviewed

Evidence ID	Source	Collection / query method	Time range	Integrity or quality note	Location / reference
EV-001					

Use the separate evidence log for detailed records.

8. Queries performed

Query ID	Data source	Query / filter	Time range	Result summary	Next pivot
Q-001					

Use the query journal when more detail is required.

9. Analysis

Interpretation

Explain what the combined facts suggest. Connect evidence through identity, time, process, network, session, request, file or resource pivots.

Alternative explanations considered

Alternative	Evidence supporting it	Evidence against it	Status
			Open / unlikely / ruled out

Visibility gaps and limitations

State missing data, parser failures, disconnected sources, clock issues, retention gaps or permissions that limit the conclusion.

10. Classification and confidence

Field	Entry
Classification	False positive / benign positive / suspicious / confirmed incident / insufficient evidence / data-quality issue
Confidence	Low / medium / high
Confidence reasoning	
Potential severity	Informational / low / medium / high / critical, according to assignment definitions
Business or lab impact	

11. Actions and recommendations

Actions already taken

Record only authorised actions actually performed.

1.
2.

Recommended next actions

Priority	Recommendation	Owner / escalation target	Reason	Deadline

Do not claim that a recommendation has been implemented unless evidence confirms it.

12. Escalation decision

Field	Entry
Escalated?	Yes / no
Escalated to	
Time	
Reason	
Information supplied	
Questions requiring higher-tier review	

13. Lessons and detection improvements

- Which field or source was most valuable?
- Which evidence was missing?
- Did the detection title and severity accurately describe the activity?
- What safe tuning, logging or playbook improvement is recommended?
- What should the analyst do differently next time?

14. References and attachments

List approved screenshots, exports, evidence IDs, task instructions and public references. Use repository-relative paths where possible. Redact sensitive values.

15. Reviewer notes

Reviewer	Date	Decision	Required corrections
		Approved / revise	